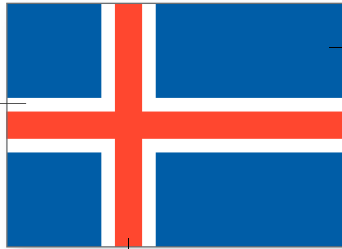


Iceland

Ratio: 18:25 **Adopted:** June 19, 1915 **Usage:** National and Civil

White recalls the ice and snow which covers Iceland



Deep blue represents the Atlantic Ocean

Red represents the fire produced by the island's volcanoes

Europe



Ruled by the Danes from the 14th century, **Iceland** became a realm within the kingdom of Denmark in 1918, and a republic in 1944.

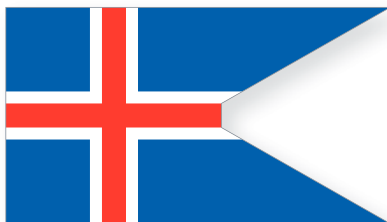
Iceland's first national flag was a white cross on a deep blue background. It was first paraded in 1897. The modern flag dates from 1915, when a red cross was inserted into the white cross of the original flag. It was adopted

in 1918 and became the national flag when Iceland gained independence from Denmark in 1944.

The naval ensign is swallow-tailed, as are the naval ensigns of all the Scandinavian countries.

NAVAL ENSIGN

The swallow-tail form is common in Scandinavia for government flags.



THE PRESIDENT'S FLAG

The shield is supported by a bull, an eagle, a dragon, and a giant, the mythical defenders of the island.

